



Department of Management Science

Fundamental Beliefs in Islam

The Foundation of Islamic
Creed



- As for 'Pillars of Islam', *the term has been used for five observable features that distinguish Islam from all other religions of the world.* These 'Pillars of Islam' include:
- To testify that there is no God but Allah and that Muhammad (BPUH) is a true Prophet of Allah;
- To offer five prayers during the day;
- To pay *Zaka'h* according to the directives of the *Shari`ah*;
- To fast during the month of *Ramadan*; and
- To undertake *Hajj* of the *Ka`bah*, if one has the ability to do so.

Difference between Articles of Faith and Pillars of Islam:



- *The term 'Articles of Faith' is generally used for the six essential elements of faith propounded by Islam.* These six 'Articles of Faith' are essential for a person to be considered a Muslim. These Articles of Faith include:
 - The belief in One God;
 - The belief in Prophet hood;
 - The belief in the Day of Judgment;
 - The belief in Angels;
 - The belief in Revealed Books;
 - The belief in Predestination.



(Belief in God)

- **Literal and Literary Meaning of Tawhid:**
- ***Literal meaning:*** Oneness of Allah or Monotheism. Tawhid is the concept of [monotheism](#) in [Islam](#).
- ***Literary Meaning:*** To believe in the Oneness of Lordship, Worship, Names and Attributes of Allah. The [Qu'ran](#) asserts the existence of a unique, independent and indivisible being, who is independent of the entire creation. God according to Islam is a universal God, rather than a local or tribal.



Three Categories of Tawhid:

- Tawhid is of following three types;
- **1-Tawhid al-Rububiyyah:** توحيد في الذات
- **2-Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah:** توحيد في العبادات
- **3-Tawhid al-Asma wa al-Sifaat:** توحيد في الصفات



توحيد في الذات: *1-Tawhid al-Rububiyyah*

- *Belief in the Oneness of the Lordship of Allah*, where it is to believe that there is only one Lord for all the universe, its Creator, Organizer, Planner, Sustainer, and the Giver of security and so on that is Allah.
- One thing can be said to these ignorant people who deny the existence of the Generous Lord: no rational person can accept an impact without an effect, or an action without a doer or a creation without a Creator. Moreover, it is quite obvious that if you see a needle, you would certainly be assured that it has a Maker. So what can be said about this marvelous bright universe, which dazzle sights? Has it been created without a Creator and found without a finder? And much more, have it been organized without an organizer, and all what exists in this universe, stars, clouds, lightening, thunders, deserts, seas, day and night, dark and light, trees and roses, jinn and mankind, Angels and animals, and all sorts of uncountable creatures? Have all of these been found without a Finder Who could create them from nothing. No one, who has a tip of rationalism, can say that. In short, proofs of Lordship of Allâh cannot be counted, and He Spoke the Truth when He said, *{Were they created of nothing, or were they themselves the creators?}*, and when He said, *{Allâh is the Creator of all things, and He is the Guardian and Disposer of all affairs}*.
- One of the rational evidences we were talking about is a debate between Abu Hanifah (May Allâh be Merciful with him) and a group of scholastic people who were arguing with him Tawhîd al-Rububiyyah (Islâmic Monotheism for Allâh's Lordship). Abu Hanifah asked them, "before we talk about this issue would you tell me about that ship in Dajlah River, which has loaded itself with food and goods, and then returned by itself, after all it anchored and emptied its goods without having someone to direct?", "this is quite impossible, and could not happen by any way!" they said, then Abu Hanifah told them, "what would you then say about all this upper and lower universe??" –and this story was narrated about someone other than Abu Hanifah.



توحيد في العبادت: 2-Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah:

- Belief in the Oneness of the Worship of Allah, where it is to believe in total obedience to Allah, that none has the right to be worshiped (praying, invoking, swearing, slaughtering sacrifices, giving charity, fasting, pilgrimage and so on) except Allah. In addition to declaring Allah as the Only God to who all acts of worship must be dedicated, such as Salah (prayers), Zakah (almsgiving), Saum (fasting), Du'aa (supplications), vowing and so on. This also includes emotions like love, trust, and fear all of which have degrees which should only be directed to Allah.
- It is called also Tawhîd al-Ibadah (Oneness of the Worship), which means to perform Monotheism for Allâh in worship because He only deserves to be worshipped not anybody else, no matter how noble and how honorable he is. Allâh said informing about Noah, {*We sent Nuh (Noah) to his People (with a mission): "I have come to you with a Clear Warning: "That you serve none but Allâh: verily I do fear for you the Penalty of a Grievous Day. And Allâh has ordered His Prophet Muhammad peace be upon him to say to the people of the Book: {"Say (O Muhammad peace be upon him): "O People of the Book! Come to common terms as between us and you: that we worship none but Allâh; that we associate no partners with Him; that we erect not, from among ourselves, Lords and patrons other than Allâh}.*



3-Tawhid al-Asma wa al-Sifaat:

- *Belief in the Oneness of the Names and the Attributes of Allah*, being affirmation of all the Divine Names and Attributes of Allah in a manner that suits His Majesty, as mentioned in the Qu'ran. "There is nothing like unto Him, and He is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer." (Qur'an:42:11).
- Tawhîd al-Asma' Wa al-Sifat (Islâmic Monotheism of Allâh's Names and Qualities) is to perform Monotheism for Allâh in His Names and Descriptions, and this should happen by confirming what He has confirmed among Names and Descriptions for Himself in His Book, or what His Messenger has confirmed to Him as well; without any Tahrif (distortion) or Ta'til (suspension), or Takyif (adaptation), or Tamthil (likening).



Shirk:

- There are two types of Shirk;
- Greater *shirk* open and apparent i.e. *Shirk e Akbar*
- Lesser *shirk* concealed or hidden i.e. *Shirk e Asghar*



Greater shirk

- Greater *shirk* or *Shirk-e-Akbar* means open polytheism. The Holy Prophet Muhammad PBUH describes major *shirk* in two forms;
- To associate anyone with Allah Ta'ala as His part
- To associate Allah's attributes with someone else
- Allah said about this kind of Shirk {*Allâh forgives not (the sin of) joining other gods with Him; but He forgives whom He pleases other sins than this*}. And He said, {*Whoever joins other gods with Allâh, Allâh will forbid him the Paradise, and the Fire will be his abode. There will for the wrongdoers be no one to help*}.



Lesser shirk:

- Lesser *shirk* or *Shirk e Asghar* means hidden polytheism. A person commits hidden polytheism when he says *tawhid*, there is no god except Allah, but his thoughts and action does not reflect his belief.
- The Holy Prophet Muhammad PBUH said; "One who offers the ritual prayers in an ostentatious way is a polytheist. One who keeps the fast, or gives alms, or performs the *Hajj* to show the public his righteousness or to earn good name is a polytheist."